
August
2026

ASMI^{nk}

Newsletter of the Archeological Society of Maryland, Inc.



Trowels to Teaching - Round 2!

By Julia Berg and Sarah Mason

From June 22 - 26, we hosted our teacher archaeology workshop, "From Trowels to Teaching," for the second year. This year, Towson University and the Baltimore Community Archaeology Lab hosted us in their classroom space. We had 14 teacher participants from counties across Maryland and from elementary school through high school. While much of the program remained the same as our pilot year in 2025, we did make some exciting updates.



As always, the highlights of the week included field work, experimental archaeology, and conversations with Indigenous Tribal Members. Teachers found that engaging in experimental flintknapping in particular helped them feel more equipped to identify flakes and debitage in the field.

Teachers also enjoyed practicing their dart-throwing skills using an atlatl.



Francis Gray of the Piscataway Conoy Tribe and Pete Landeros of the Piscataway Indian Nation joined Dr. Kat Ahlrichs for an impactful discussion about the history of archaeology and Indigenous tribes, their evolving relationship with the archaeology community, and their hopes moving forward.





Buddy Howard and Brenda Howard from the Pocomoke Indian Nation demonstrated a model lesson using traditional items created by their tribal members. Their Pop-Up Museum exhibit visits schools all over the Lower Eastern Shore along with lesson plans for teachers to use to teach students about Indigenous history.



Of course, no archaeology workshop is complete without field work! We excavated at the precontact McWilliams site in Baltimore. Teachers learned how to shovel, screen, trowel, and map alongside Towson



University students, who were able to instruct others in archaeological methods for the first time.



On our final day of the workshop, teachers engaged in a collaborative work session with professional archaeologists and archaeology students on what archaeologists need to understand about schools, and how to



remove or overcome barriers to make archaeology classroom-ready.

Archaeologists came prepared with lesson plans, which teachers were able to critique and modify in real-time based on the needs and logistics of their schools and classrooms. Both the teachers and the archaeologists felt this session was invaluable.

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As with last year, the archaeology- focused lesson plans our teachers create will be publicly available on MHT's website.



Finally, we want to thank our incredible guest speakers and professional archaeologist participants for lending their expertise to help make this program not only possible in the first place, but truly authentic for teachers:

- Dr. Matt McKnight, MHT
- Dr. Zac Singer, MHT
- Francis Gray, Piscataway Conoy Tribe
- Pete Landeros, Piscataway Indian Nation

- Buddy Howard, Pocomoke Indian Nation
- Brenda Howard, Pocomoke Indian Nation
- Steph Soder, MHT
- Scott Strickland, MAC Lab
- Jordan Riggs, Preservation Maryland
- Aaron Levinthal, DNR
- Stephen Israel
- Ryun Papson
- Jessica Papson
- Dr. Rob Ahlrichs
- Daniel Fellman, MHT
- All of the TU/BCAL students

This project was generously funded by grants and donations from:

- The Maryland Historical Trust
- The Baltimore County Commission on Arts & Sciences
- Preservation Maryland
- The Archaeological Society of Maryland, Inc.
- The Institute for Heritage Education
- Duane Schmidt and Christine Daily



Board Notes:

Happy August! While we are out enjoying the sunshine and family and friends, there are still archeology activities occurring.

The board is reviewing an Analysis Fund request and the Fiscal Year 2027 ASM Budget. Our Fiscal Year runs from July 1 - June 26th and I hope to share it with you in the September Ink.

The By-Laws committee is also reviewing some suggested updates, I hope to send the final draft out to the membership soon for consideration and vote at the Annual Meeting in October.

Speaking of fall activities, please add the Upcoming Events to your calendar - we are looking forward to seeing everyone at the Workshop in Maryland Archeology in September and our ASM Annual Meeting.

Please also consider the other activities listed, some local and others around the country. You are welcome to join us at all of them. Hope to see you soon!



Upcoming Events

Third Annual Summit of Maryland Indigenous People and Archeologists

September 11, 2026 - 9am - 4pm
Hanover, MD

ASM Board Meeting

September 12, 2026 - Virtual

Workshop in Maryland Archeology

September 26, 2026 - Maryland Historical Trust in Crownsville, MD

ASM Annual Meeting

October 10, 2026 - Josiah Henson Museum and Park, Bethesda, MD

Paleoamerican Odyssey

Santa Fe, New Mexico

October 14-17, 2026

[Center For the Study of the First Americans](#)

American Indian Heritage Day

November 7, 2026 at Jefferson Patterson Park and Museum

93rd Annual ESAF Meeting

November 11-15, 2026, Norwalk, CT

ASM Elections

2026 ASM Board of Trustee elections are underway. All active ASM members should have received a ballot through their registered e-mail address. Anyone who hasn't received a ballot can contact :

John Fiveash, ASM Elections Committee
(jsfiveash@marylandarcheology.org)

Maryland Archeology Past Portraits

Louis A Kengla (1861-1904)



“Louis A. Kengla’s achievements in regional archaeology were attained at an early age while still a medical student at Georgetown University. While completing his B.S. in 1882, he researched, described and illustrated in his detailed paper, *Contributions to the Archaeology of the District of Columbia*. This report was the first prehistoric synthesis of the metropolitan area, preceding the publication of S.V. Proudfit’s (1889) “Ancient Village Sites and Aboriginal Workshops in the District of Columbia” by seven years.

While completing his A.B. in 1883, he conducted investigations for and wrote “Stone Mounds of Hampshire Co., W.Va.” (Kengla 1885). This lesser known study described burial mounds in eastern West Virginia.” He undertook early studies and speculation on knives, points and soapstones in the Potomac Valley.

Portions of his collections are curated at Georgetown University and at the Smithsonian Institute as early as 1881 and 1885. See accounts by S.V. Proudfit, William Henry Holmes, and Paul Inashima. (Paul Y. Inashima, *Early Contributors to Regional Archaeology: Louis A. Kengla (1862-1904)*, December 2014, ASV Quarterly Bulletin 69 (4): 195-210.

Kenga was well received by the local scholars, although he turned down a professorship of archaeology at Smithsonian in 1883. He donated his artifact collection to the National Museum of Natural History (NMNH) in 1886, when he moved to San Francisco, California to practice general medicine. Kenga, over the years, maintained a relationship with William Henry Holmes and S. V. Proudfit at the NMNH.

Past Portraits is a project to document the stories of people who have contributed to archeology in Maryland. This series highlights personalities that have contributed to archeology in Maryland over time. ASMIInk will publish excerpts from this series over time.

-- Stephen Israel (Archaeology of Eastern North America, Vol,48 (2020)

Chapter News

Central Chapter

Central Chapter meetings are by Zoom only. Katharine Fernstrom sends the link to the email group. Stay tuned for more details. For more information and to be added to the Zoom list contact Katharine Fernstrom at katharine.fernstrom@marylandarcheology.org

Charles County

Meets in person September through April at the Community Room of the LaPlata Police Department in LaPlata, MD on the third Thursday of the month. Email ccasm2010@gmail.com for more information.

Eastern Shore

Dates and events are on the chapter's website ([ASM Eastern Shore](#)), Facebook page ([Eastern Shore Maryland Archaeology](#)) and Instagram (@esmdarch). For more information, email esarcheology@gmail.com or jmrkin2@washcoll.edu

Calendar is here: bit.ly/ASM-ES and events are open to members and nonmembers. To be added to our social media updates, email esarcheology@gmail.com.

All events are open to anyone who wants to attend!

Open lab at Washington College: Contact Julie Markin at jmarkin2@washcoll.edu.

Mid-Potomac

The chapter meets the third Thursday of the month from September through June. In-person meetings begin at 7p.m. for the business meeting followed by a presentation at around 7:30. The chapter meets at the ADU Showroom, 8501 Grovemont Circle, Gaithersburg, MD 20877. Please contact Don Housley for directions, if necessary.

Pizza will be available before the in-person meeting starting at 6:30pm for \$6 per person. If virtual meetings are necessary, they will be via Zoom with the business meeting also starting at 7 p.m. and the presentation around 7:30. Contact Don Housley to RSVP for pizza by 12 noon on the day of the meeting and for virtual Zoom meeting codes.

September 17, 2026: Zac Singer, MHT's Terrestrial Archeologist, will talk on the results of the Paleo Point blood protein analysis.

October 15, 2026: Don Housley, chapter president, will speak on the 2026 Field Session at Teague's Point.

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For up-to-date information concerning meetings, please contact [Don Housley](#), 301-424-8526, check the [Mid-Potomac Chapter Website](#) or send an email to: asmmidpotomac@gmail.com.

Monocacy

For information contact: monocacyarcheology@gmail.com (mailbox monitored intermittently) or call Jeremy Lazelle at 301-471-8433.

Northern Chesapeake

A business meeting at 7pm and is followed by the presentation at 7:30. Locations vary. Contact Dan Coates at 410-808-2398 or dancoates@comcast.net

Western Maryland

Programs are held the fourth Friday of the month, at 7:30 pm at the **History Discovery Center at Blue Spring at 400 N. Mechanic Street, Cumberland, MD**. Unless noted. Chapter email: wmdasm@yahoo.com

Meeting announcements are sent also to CTN; WFWM, and the Oakland Republican.

Contact Us

The **Archeological Society of Maryland Inc.** is a statewide nonprofit organization devoted to the study and conservation of Maryland archeology.



ASM members receive the monthly newsletter, ASM Ink, publication notice of the biannual journal, MARYLAND ARCHEOLOGY, reduced admission to ASM events and a 10-percent discount on items sold by the Society.

Contact Membership Secretary Ethan Bean, ethan.bean@marylandarcheology.org, for membership rates.

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